

Accounts held under pressure. Commercial trust built through consistent execution.

Across twenty-six years in media networks, web agencies, direct marketing, and enterprise technology, long-term retention has relied on a single operational principle: earned trust. Account stability is not created by transactional sales closes, but by showing up consistently, understanding the client's operational reality, and aligning commercial terms to mutual long-term success.

VERIFIED PERFORMANCE METRICS

0%

Churn across enterprise portfolio during 2020 disruption

8 Years

Consecutive renewals at Santa Maria College

26 Yrs

Career tenure holding accounts across 8 roles

108

Direct 1-on-1 diagnostic sessions in 2020 lockdown

METHODOLOGY

Strategy without operational reality is just advice. Sustainable retention requires earned trust.

Trust is built through predictable execution, active listening, and total alignment with client business objectives. The Four-Stage Account Engine turns strategic account management into a repeatable, revenue-protecting operational sequence.

STAGE 01

OBSERVE

Active listening & discovery. Time spent on-site or in 1-on-1 sessions applying the LAER framework to uncover friction before proposing solutions.

STAGE 02

PROTECT

Relationship defense under pressure. Intervening during operational disruption or market shifts by solving execution breakdowns directly.

STAGE 03

STRUCTURE

Aligning commercial terms. Converting informal support into advance-billed recurring service lines aligned with client financial KPIs.

STAGE 04

SCALE

Organic account growth. Expanding retained accounts into multi-site rollouts and long-term contracts based on proven operational trust.

SELECTED CASES

Four operational moments defined by trust, active listening, and commercial structure.

Lockdown 2020 · 108 Client Calls · 0% Churn

Case 01: The Lockdown Retention Operation (2020)

OPERATIONAL FOCUS: TIME MANAGEMENT & EMPATHETIC COMMUNICATION — Executing 108 individual video diagnostics to stabilize an entire book.

108 individual face-to-face sessions to protect account relationships through global disruption.

When lockdown disruption hit in 2020, generic email updates were replaced with immediate, structured client outreach. A systematic schedule of 108 one-on-one video diagnostic sessions was conducted with key decision-makers and frontline users across the entire portfolio.

Direct engagement revealed acute operational friction: teaching staff and administrators were struggling with sudden remote delivery. During one session, a key lead expressed explicit resistance to the platform. Rather than presenting product features, active listening was used to isolate her specific daily bottlenecks and re-align system workflows directly to her immediate goals. By the call's end, the user recognized the platform's practical utility and transitioned into one of the account's strongest internal champions.

Outcome: Zero customer loss across the enterprise book during the 2020 disruption period. Prioritizing individual relationships under pressure turned high-risk accounts into resilient, multi-year partnerships.

Multi-Campus Network · Retained Mid-Defection · Expansion to 6th Site

Case 02: Multi-Campus Ground Operation (2018–2019)

Rebuilding client trust from active defection to multi-site expansion.

An Australian five-campus network was actively evaluating alternative software vendors to replace their central system. Rather than negotiating via remote calls or offering price concessions, an intensive on-site operation was deployed across all five campuses over five days.

Shadowing campus leadership, administrators, and classroom staff exposed a crucial operational disconnect: the threat of churn was driven by fragmented adoption and inconsistent staff enablement across locations. A unified growth and user-engagement strategy was designed on-site to bridge these operational gaps and connect resources across all sites. A second on-site deployment was executed to deliver executive alignment and direct staff training.

Outcome: Retained the multi-campus network mid-defection. Expanded the partnership to include a sixth campus, while establishing two new recurring commercial lines: a paid consultancy engagement and an annual managed services agreement.

2000AD NYE 1999 · Major Private Millennium Event · Concept Monetization

Case 03: Selling the Sunrise Concept Before Asset Creation (1999)

Securing national sponsor commitments on the strength of positioning and shared vision.

2000AD was conceived as New Zealand's largest private millennium event—a New Year's Eve celebration transitioning into the year 2000, featuring a dual-stage national artist line-up and a broadcast reaching the BBC.

At nineteen years old, major corporate sponsorships had to be structured and sold before stages were built or physical assets existed. Commercial alignment was established around a central strategic positioning point: New Zealand would be among the first places on Earth to witness the new millennium's sunrise. Working in coordination with broadcast partners like TVNZ, national brands were pitched on the unique promotional value of that exact moment.

Outcome: Secured full national event sponsorship prior to site construction. The resulting performance lineup included prominent New Zealand musical acts (including The Exponents, Bongmaster, and Mark de Clive-Lowe), proving early that commercial relationships depend on clear positioning and understanding what a moment is truly worth.

Case 04: The Structural Failure & Diagnostic Lesson (2006–2009)

A \$400,000 lesson in user capabilities vs. software delivery.

Between media sales roles and agency account management, MySimpleSiteMan was founded and operated as a self-serve website engine for New Zealand small businesses at \$399/year. Over three years, more than \$400,000 was invested into platform architecture and infrastructure.

Despite a working product, the business was deliberately closed. The root breakdown lay in an operational misjudgment: providing non-technical business owners with software assumed they possessed the strategic skill to structure converting copy and layouts. The software was limited to 3-to-6 page brochure sites with no pathway for account expansion.

Outcome: A foundational career lesson: software tools without active enablement and ongoing strategic alignment lead to stagnation. This operational insight shaped the account management methodology applied across all subsequent roles: technology delivery must always be paired with structured execution support.

EXECUTION RECORD

Twenty-six years of relationship stability, pricing design, and account growth.

A continuous 25-year record across eight roles: understanding client goals, establishing earned trust, structuring commercial offers, and holding the accounts won.

1. Event Director

2000AD (1999)

Skill: Value Positioning

Monetized an unbuilt millennium event concept, securing national sponsorship commitments and TVNZ alignment for a major broadcast by leveraging positioning around the new millennium sunrise.

2. BD & Account Mgr

Adplus / Tracta (2001–2003)

Skill: Relationship Continuity

Held flagship Hawke's Bay Tourism account personally. Grew total ad revenue by ~60% and advertiser volume by ~40% over 3 years, while introducing early digital packages (+14% deal size).

3. Media Sales

Canwest / Radioworks (2003–2006)

Skill: Earned Trust

Kept the Harvey Norman account for full tenure while achieving 10%–20% annual account growth (peaking at 178% of budget). Executed creative campaigns like the "Steak Out Challenge".

4. Founder

MySimpleSiteMan (2006–2009)

Skill: Strategic Adaptability

Invested \$400,000+ developing a self-serve CMS. Recognized the limits of unguided self-service models, reshaping future consultative account management frameworks.

5. Account Strategy

Xplore (2009–2013)

Skill: Proactive Organization

Held HB Chamber of Commerce account for 4 years. Closed \$70k enterprise builds (Rembrandt), founded Xchange referral network (\$70k+ generated), and established recurring SEO lines.

6. Sales & Marketing Mgr

99 Corporation (2013–2015)

Skill: Business Goal Alignment

Introduced setup fees, scriptwriting charges, and mandatory 50% deposits. Increased total business clients by ~70% and income by ~120% (+30% profit per customer).

7. Senior Leader / GM

EdTech Sector (2015–2025)

Skill: Strategic Retention

Established 6 revenue lines. Secured 8 consecutive renewals at Sancta Maria College. Renegotiated vendor terms to eliminate licence floors and enable buy-as-needed pricing. 0% churn in 2020.

8. Strategic Advisory

Clarity Engine AI / Pikle (2025–Pres)

Skill: AI Integration

Applying 26 years of commercial account strategy, earned trust, and retention frameworks to modern AI workflows and enterprise technology positioning.

PRESENT VENTURES & CONTACT

Applying account management discipline to modern AI systems.

Combining proven retention frameworks, active listening, and commercial pricing models with practical AI implementation for enterprise teams and technology providers.

CLARITY ENGINE AI

Strategic advisory for enterprise tech teams, education providers, and AI application deployment.

PIKLE

Commercial positioning, sales systems, and pipeline architecture built for account retention and growth.

Initiate a Conversation

Whether looking to secure high-stakes customer accounts during market transitions, monetize unbilled support lines, or deploy structured AI workflows, conversations begin with a direct review of operational realities.

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